criticism that the government had not done enough to protect Indian security, Delhi wanted to spend much more on defense than it had before.

Despite these differences, until Nehru's death in May 1964 and through his successor Lal Bahadur Shastri's twenty-month term, India continued to need the US for both its defense and its development objectives. Delhi, however, saw Washington's slow response, as well as its pressure to limit defense acquisitions and make peace with Pakistan, as counterproductive to its China strategy and general security objectives. During the rest of Kennedy's term and that of his successor, the US, in turn, continued to need India not to fail. Thus, the US aided India militarily and economically. Washington, however, saw India's defense spending at the expense of its development efforts, continuing conflict with Pakistan, different approach to Vietnam, and growing defense relationship with Moscow as counterproductive to America's China strategy and overall security objectives. Thus the US-India defense relationship briefly deepened before plateauing, and the development relationship found itself on a downward trajectory as well. In the midst of this, the 1965 India-Pakistan war—during which China threatened to intervene—reminded the US and India not just why they remained tethered to each other but also that the other was not living up to its billing.

This chapter, covering 1963 to 1965, first outlines the period after the Sino-Indian war and US-India cooperation and its limits in the final year of the Kennedy administration. It considers the two countries' postwar defense cooperation, the debate among American officials about further military assistance to India, American efforts to facilitate an India-Pakistan rapprochement and the Indian reaction, and the continuing defense discussions that led to the signing of an air defense agreement. The next section considers the leadership transitions in the US and India, and how the Johnson and Shastri governments dealt with China-related questions of defense-versus-development expenditures, Soviet military aid to India, and the Sino-Pakistan relationship until April 1965. The next section deals with the developing American and Indian disappointments that spring and summer over the other's approach toward Vietnam and over Indian capacity building to meet the China challenge. The final section looks at the 1965 war and how China's role in it served as a reminder to the US and India of the importance of continuing to engage with each other.